GOOGLE'S DISAVOW TOOL

Do you still need it?

For most

sites: no.



What Google says, when it helps, and how to build the file.

Swipe

1 What Google says

> **"Most sites will not need to use this tool."**
>
> Google's Disavow links help page

Google says its own systems can work out which links to trust without your help.



2 Disavow only if both are true

1

Lots of spammy, artificial or low-quality links point at your site

2

They caused a manual action, or likely will



3 Use it when

You have a manual action
for unnatural links

You bought links
or joined a link scheme

A past SEO built
paid links for you

Your own links, a lot of them, and you can't get them removed.



4 Skip it when

- **A tool flags "toxic" links**
  you never built
- **Rankings dropped and you**
  only suspect links
- **It's routine cleanup**
  Google's Mueller: not maintenance

"Toxic" is the tool's own score, not a Google signal.



5 Do it in this order

1. **Ask the sites**
   to remove the links
2. **Disavow**
   what is left
3. **Manual action?**
   File a reconsideration request



6 The file itself

```
domain:example.com

# one URL or domain per line

# a .txt in UTF-8 or ASCII

# up to 100,000 lines, 2MB

# a new upload replaces the old list
```

Full guide on the SerpCrest blog:

"Do you still need Google's disavow tool?"

